

1. There are no guarantees in investing. She suggested a mutual fund that includes investments in multiple big groups of companies (referred to as a “portfolio”) so your eggs aren’t all in one basket.
2. Don’t think of it as gambling, but rather as making an investment in the future of the American economy. Even if you feel that you don’t know anything, everyone is playing a game. You deserve a spot at the table if you want it.
3. Women are not, as the stereotype goes, risk averse. They are risk *aware*, Krawcheck said. (And I’m sure other marginalized people are similar.) This is not a bad thing. Get all the books or read all the credible websites so you can learn the terminology. Don’t be afraid to do the research and ask the questions.
4. Look for people and companies that serve people similar to you. Krawcheck said a lot of investing advice for women is gendered and cutesy, citing, “Don’t buy shoes, ladies! Invest!” (This is why she created Ellevest.) Get your money advice from people who can relate to you on your level. There are, for example, not that many LGBTQ financial advisers, but one I spoke to, Natalie Miller, is one of the first out trans financial advisers in the country. Times are changing!
5. Even if you are a cis woman with a cis male partner, don’t let him take the reins on your money or investments because you don’t want to be bothered or to lean on average gendered stereotypes. Krawcheck said retirement homes are 80 percent single women. You have to learn this on your own.
6. Start now. Even if you don’t have that much, Krawcheck said, most women who have paid off debt should be investing 10 percent of their salary instead of only gaining small interest in a stagnant savings account.